



MindShift

PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES



A MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES GUIDE

5 Questions to Ask When Choosing the Right Therapist

*Fit matters as much as credentials. Here's how to find out if it's
there.*

Southern California • Individual, Couples & Family Psychotherapy
www.mindshiftwellnesscenter.com • (714) 584-9700



You're Allowed to Interview Your Therapist

NOTES & REFLECTION



Fit Predicts Outcome

What good fit tends to feel like

- ## NOTES & REFLECTION

What would it feel like to be fully heard by a therapist? Describe it in a sentence or two.

Ask These Five

Training in your specific concern (anxiety, trauma, relationships, teens) matters more than years in practice alone. A confident, specific answer is a good sign.

Ask directly whether they draw on CBT, EMDR, DBT, ACT, or psychodynamic work, and why that approach fits your concern. They should be glad you asked.

Good therapists set collaborative goals and check progress along the way, not just “how did the week go.”

Jot down how a therapist answers question 1, 2, and 3 during your consult call.



Two More, Plus Red Flags

Clarify session frequency, cancellation policy, and whether they take your insurance or offer a sliding scale before you invest emotionally in the fit.

You should feel explicitly invited to say “this approach isn't landing for me.” A defensive answer here is worth noting.

- They dodge questions about training or approach.
- You consistently feel unheard, judged, or rushed.
- No clear plan or goals after several sessions.

Jot down how a therapist answers question 4 and 5, plus your overall gut check.



BRING THIS WITH YOU

My Consultation Call Notes

Jot answers during (or right after) each consultation call so you can compare therapists fairly.

Therapist name & specialty:

.....

Their answer on experience with my concern:

.....

.....

Their approach / modalities:

.....

.....

Logistics (cost, insurance, availability):

.....

.....

Gut check, how did I feel talking with them?

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.....

BEFORE YOU GO

You Don't Have to Carry This Alone

Reaching for a resource like this one is already an act of self-care. If anything here resonated, know that our licensed California clinicians are ready to help you go deeper — with real support, tailored to your story, at a pace that feels right for you.

Rachael Morua, LMFT, CST

License #LMFT106917 • Founder, MindShift Psychological Services
On behalf of the licensed clinicians of the MindShift care team

MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES

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IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS

Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911. You deserve support right now.



Visit Our Website



Contact Us to Get Started

